



BY MOLLY MADIGAN PISULA

— 5 easy —

FRENCH DESSERTS

VANILLA BEAN CUISINE



MOLLY MADIGAN PISULA

Chef Molly received her certificate in French pastry in 2004, then spent over 12 years as a personal chef. Now Molly runs the recipe blog, [Vanilla Bean Cuisine](#), featuring French-inspired seasonal recipes for both everyday and entertaining.

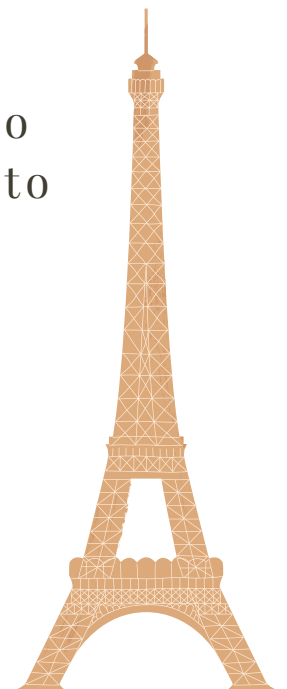
Welcome!

I'm so glad you found me. French baking is a passion of mine, and I'm here to tell you that contrary to expectations, it does not have to be complicated.

Read on for some of my favorite classic French baking recipes—I promise you do not need to spend hours in the kitchen to make desserts your people will love!

Bon Appétit!

Chef Molly





French Yogurt Cake



8 servings



40 minutes

INGREDIENTS

butter, for greasing pan

1 cup all-purpose flour

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup almond flour

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup sugar

2 teaspoons baking powder

$\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon kosher salt

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup plain, full-fat yogurt

3 eggs

1 teaspoon vanilla extract

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup olive oil

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup sliced or blanched almonds

DIRECTIONS

1. Preheat oven to 350° Fahrenheit.
2. Butter the sides and bottom of a 9-inch round cake pan and line the bottom with parchment paper.
3. In a medium bowl, combine the flours, sugar, baking powder, and salt, and whisk gently.
4. In a large bowl, whisk together the yogurt, eggs, vanilla extract, and olive oil until the oil is fully incorporated.
5. Then add the dry ingredients to the liquid ingredients. Stir just until the batter comes together.
6. Pour the batter into the pan, and sprinkle the sliced almonds on the top.
7. Bake for 25-30 minutes, until top is golden brown, and a toothpick comes out almost cleanly.
8. Remove cake from oven and put onto a cake rack to cool.
9. After 15 minutes, when cake is still warm, invert cake pan onto a plate to unmold, remove parchment paper, and then flip right-side up again.
10. Sprinkle with powdered sugar to serve, adding fresh berries if desired.



Strawberry Parfait



4 servings



15 minutes

INGREDIENTS

- 8 ounces fresh strawberries
- 5 ounces biscoff cookies (about 18 cookies)
- 8 ounces mascarpone cheese
- $\frac{1}{2}$ cup heavy cream
- 2 tablespoons granulated sugar

NOTES

Substitute any kind of fruit or berries.
Graham crackers, granola, and even pound cake can be used instead of biscoff cookies.

DIRECTIONS

1. Rinse, trim, and finely chop strawberries.
2. Put biscoff cookies into a ziplock bag, then crush with the back of a measuring cup or a wooden spoon or meat mallet, until you have small chunks and crumbs. (Up to you how fine you want the crumbs to be.)
3. Whip mascarpone until smooth with mixer, about 1 minute.
4. Add heavy cream and sugar, and whip for another 2 minutes until light and creamy.
5. Assemble parfaits by layering first a couple of spoonfuls of biscoff crumbs, followed by a couple of spoonfuls of the mascarpone mixture, followed by a sprinkling of strawberry pieces. You really don't need to measure out exactly, just roughly eyeball the amount of the ingredients you have and make sure you have enough for 2 layers in each serving dish or glass.
6. Repeat with the second layer, ending with strawberries.
7. Serve immediately.



Cinnamon Twists



8 servings



20 minutes

INGREDIENTS

2–3 tablespoons sugar

1 teaspoon ground cinnamon

1 tablespoon flour (for rolling out
dough)

1 egg

1 sheet puff pastry dough

DIRECTIONS

1. Preheat oven to 400° Fahrenheit. Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Stir 2 tablespoons sugar and cinnamon together in a small bowl. Taste, and add more sugar if you'd like the mixture a little sweeter.
3. Sprinkle flour over a large cutting board.
4. Unfold puff pastry sheet, and roll gently with a rolling pin to even out the surface and flatten just a little.
5. Whisk egg in a small bowl to make egg wash.
6. Use a pastry brush to brush the egg wash in a thin layer all over the rolled out dough.
7. Sprinkle most of the cinnamon sugar evenly over the dough, reserving a little.
8. Cut dough vertically into slices that are close to 1-inch wide.
9. Pick up each strip, hold each end, and twist several times.
10. Place twists on baking sheet, leaving an inch of space between them. (You may need to bake these in two batches if they don't all fit on your baking sheet.)
11. Brush any exposed dough not covered in cinnamon sugar with egg wash and sprinkle with reserved sugar.
12. Bake for 15 minutes, until puffed and golden brown.



Nutella Crêpes



4 servings



20 minutes active

INGREDIENTS

1 cup flour

1 cup milk

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup water

2 eggs

2 tablespoons butter, melted

$\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon kosher salt

2 tablespoons butter for cooking

8 tablespoons Nutella

DIRECTIONS

1. Combine the flour, milk, water, eggs, butter, and salt in a blender, and blend until the mixture is smooth—about 10 seconds. The batter should be much thinner than pancake batter—closer to the consistency of heavy cream.
2. Let the batter rest for at least an hour, and up to overnight.
3. When your batter is ready, heat your crêpe pan or nonstick skillet on medium, cut off a sliver of butter, and swirl it around your pan. Then use a paper towel to coat the pan.
4. Pour about $\frac{1}{4}$ cup of batter directly in the center of the pan, then quickly lift the pan up and roll your wrist around as you hold it, so that the batter spreads out in a thin even layer over the pan.
5. Cook until you see the lacy edges begin to brown, then use a non-scratch spatula to flip your crêpe and cook the other side.
6. Repeat with the rest of your crêpes, including buttering the pan between each.
7. As you finish your crêpes, stack them on a plate separated by squares of wax paper or parchment paper.
8. Spread each crêpe with a generous tablespoon of Nutella.
9. Roll up or fold over twice to make a triangular packet.



Cherry Compote



4-6 servings



25 minutes

INGREDIENTS

1 pound fresh cherries

3 tablespoons sugar

1 tablespoon water

Pinch of salt

½ teaspoon vanilla extract

DIRECTIONS

1. Use a cherry pitter or a sharp knife to remove the pits from your cherries. You should have about 2 $\frac{3}{4}$ cups of de-pitted cherries.
2. Combine cherries and sugar in a medium saucepan with water and salt.
3. Place over medium heat.
4. Cook until sugar dissolves and cherries soften, about 15 minutes. Compote will thicken slightly.
5. Stir in vanilla.
6. Let cool completely, then put into an airtight container and refrigerate for up to a week.

NOTES

Try this compote as a topping for ice cream, waffles, pancakes, or oatmeal. It also makes a very pretty holiday gift!

Thank you for reading!

I hope you found a few new recipes to inspire you in the kitchen. If you have any questions, you can always reach me at

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or connect via one of my social channels below.

And to get more information about the recipes I featured here, including step-by-step photos, see:

<https://www.vanillabeancuisine.com/french-yogurt-cake-with-almonds/>

<https://www.vanillabeancuisine.com/strawberry-parfait-with-mascarpone-cream/>

<https://www.vanillabeancuisine.com/cinnamon-twists/>

<https://www.vanillabeancuisine.com/nutella-crepes/>

<https://www.vanillabeancuisine.com/cherry-compote/>



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